

Industrial Asset Maintenance Handbook

General Guidelines for Pumps, Chillers, Motors & HVAC Systems
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1. General Safety Guidelines

Electrical Safety

- Always de-energize equipment before performing maintenance
- Use lockout/tagout procedures per OSHA requirements
- Test for absence of voltage using calibrated meter
- Wait 5 minutes after shutdown before opening enclosures
- Ground anti-static equipment when working with electronics

Mechanical Safety

- Use appropriate PPE: hard hat, safety glasses, work gloves, steel-toe boots
- Never wear loose clothing or jewelry near rotating equipment
- Assume all fluids are hot until proven otherwise
- Use proper lifting techniques for items >25 kg (55 lbs)
- Have spill kits available when servicing hydraulic/coolant systems

Pressure System Safety

- Release pressure gradually using proper bleed-down procedures
- Never strike or heat pressurized vessels or lines
- Isolate from power and use mechanical locks on isolation valves
- Verify pressure gauge reads zero before disconnecting
- Replace pressure relief valves annually or per manufacturer

2. Predictive Maintenance Techniques

Vibration Analysis

Vibration monitoring detects early failures in rotating equipment.

ISO 20816 Standards:

- Zone A (0-7.1 mm/s): Acceptable - new equipment baseline
- Zone B (7.1-11.2 mm/s): Just Acceptable - monitor closely
- Zone C (11.2-18 mm/s): Unacceptable - schedule maintenance within 1 week
- Zone D (>18 mm/s): Machine In Imminent Failure - shutdown immediately

Thermal Imaging

Detect hot spots indicating:

- Electrical connections: Loose connections create heat
- Motor bearings: High friction = high temperature
- Heat exchangers: Blockage or fouling reduces thermal transfer
- Hydraulic lines: Temperature rise indicates pressure drop or leakage

Oil Analysis

Monthly oil sampling reveals:

- Particle count: >1000 particles indicates wear

- Water content: >500 ppm suggests seal failure or ambient moisture
- Viscosity change: >±5% from baseline indicates degradation
- Acid number (TAN): >2 mg KOH/g suggests oxidation

Acoustic Monitoring

High-frequency sound analysis detects bearing degradation and cavitation:

- Normal bearings: 500-2000 Hz baseline sound signature
- Early wear: 2000-5000 Hz increase in harmonic content
- Cavitation: Distinctive crackling or popping sounds
- Frequency trending: Increasing trend indicates imminent failure

3. Common Failure Modes by Equipment Type

Pump Failures

1. Cavitation: Low suction pressure → vapor bubbles → erosion
Prevention: Maintain minimum NPSH, warm liquid carefully on startup
2. Seal failure: Chemical attack, heat degradation, pressure spikes
Prevention: Monitor temperature <45°C, control pressure ramps
3. Bearing wear: Inadequate lubrication, contamination, misalignment
Prevention: Oil change every 2000 hours, maintain alignment ±0.1mm

Chiller Failures

1. Refrigerant leakage: Corrosion, vibration fatigue, connection looseness
Prevention: Pressure test annually, monitor superheat
2. Heat exchanger fouling: Water scale, biological growth, corrosion
Prevention: Water treatment program, chemical cleaning annually
3. Compressor failure: Liquid slugging, oil starvation, overheating
Prevention: Maintain proper oil level, superheat >4°C

Motor Failures

1. Winding insulation breakdown: Thermal stress, moisture, contamination
Prevention: Keep ambient <50°C, enclosure IP54 or better
2. Bearing seals failure: Water ingress, contaminant infiltration
Prevention: Monitor leakage at drain holes, replace seals every 3 years
3. Rotor bar cracking: Thermal cycling, magnetic stress
Prevention: Avoid frequent start/stop cycles, ensure proper cooling

4. Recommended Inspection Schedule

Equipment	Daily	Weekly	Monthly	Annually
Pump	Temp/Sound	Log readings	Vibration	Seal inspection
Chiller	Pressure/Temp	Oil level	Heat exchanger	Diagnostics
Motor	Temp/Amperage	Lubrication	Bearing play	Insulation test
HVAC	Filter	Drainage	Coil clean	System pressure

5. Record Keeping & Documentation

Detailed maintenance records are essential for:

- Trending equipment performance over time
- Identifying patterns before catastrophic failures
- Supporting warranty claims
- Compliance with regulatory requirements
- Justifying capital equipment replacement

Required Documentation:

- Work order with date, time, technician name, nature of work
- Before/after sensor readings (temperature, pressure, vibration)
- Parts replaced with manufacturer part numbers and quantities
- Special observations, recommendations, safety issues
- Estimated time to complete and actual time spent